	INTERNAL AUDITS PROCEDURE
	Document no: ASMF 8.7

Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**	
Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

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Introduction

This procedure is developed as a guideline for Azuresky (Pty) Ltd to follow when conducting internal laboratory audits. The objective is to assess for compliance to requirements stipulated as per ISO 17025:2017; ISO 17034:2016; ISO 17043:2023 and other relevant SANAS codes of practice.

Supporting Clauses

Scope

This procedure details the activities performed when conducting internal laboratory audit. The procedure covers the process to be followed by Azuresky (Pty) Ltd management.

Purpose

The purpose of this procedure is to describe the requirements for planning, executing audits, establishing records and reporting results of the audits.

Normative/Informative References

Normative

[1] ISO 17034:2016: General requirements for the competence of reference material producers

[2] ISO 17043:2023: General requirements for the competence of proficiency testing providers

[3] ISO 17025:2017: General requirements for the competence of testing and calibration laboratories

[4] ISO 19011:2018: Guidance for auditing management systems

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Informative

[5] ISO 9001: 2015 Quality Management Systems – Requirements

Definitions

Table 1: Definitions

Definition	Description
Audit	Systematic, independent and documented process for obtaining audit objective evidence and evaluating it objectively to determine the extent to which the audit criteria is fulfilled
Audit criteria	Set of policies, procedures or requirements used as a reference against audit evidence.
Audit Evidence	Records, statements of fact or other information which are relevant to the statements to the audit criteria.
Audit Conclusion	Outcome of an audit, after consideration of the audit objectives and all audit findings
Auditee	Person/Organization being audited.
Auditor	Person who conducts the audit.
Audit Programme	Description of the activities and arrangements of an audit.
Common sample	Sample collected for more than one intended use.
Conformity	Fulfilment of a requirement
Horizontal Audit	ISO 17025 Management Requirement Assessment
Major non conformance	A non-conformance that may have potential impact on the Quality Management System and may reduce its ability to assure the controlled Processes and may have potential impact to the credibility of the final analytical results which may pose a high risk to the business.
Minor non conformance	Sporadic lapse in the system caused by not adhering to the standard and procedures at all the times. It may not directly affect the quality of results but when left unattended it can lead to a system failure.
Non-Conformity	Non-fulfilment of a requirement.
Observation	A statement of fact made during and audit and substantiated by objective evidence

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Definition	Description
Vertical Audit	ISO 17025 Technical Requirement Assessments.

Roles and Responsibilities

The roles and responsibility are shown in Table 2 below:

Table 2: Roles and responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Lead auditor	Lead the laboratory compliance audit process and compile the audit report. Discuss the outcome of the audit
Auditor	Conduct activities as requested and detailed by the Lead auditor
Auditee's contract person	Avail the laboratory for the inspection as detailed by the scope of the audit. Conduct activities and provide data as requested and detailed by the Lead auditor
Auditees	Comply with the directives of the Lead auditor and other auditors

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Laboratory Audit Procedure

Azuresky management shall be responsible for scheduling and performing laboratory audits. The overview of the audit procedure is illustrated below. The management team shall:

- Step 1: plan the audit,
- Step 2: communicate planned audit,
- Step 3: execute planned audit and record all non-conformities
- Step 4: Compile audit report
- Step 5: Address all non-conformities recorded
- Step 6: Close the audit and share the report with all personnel.

laboratory audit schedule

The schedule of the laboratory audit programme shall be developed by Management team and reviewed annually or when risks and opportunities that which required continuous evaluation through audits are identified. The audit program shall be signed off by the Operations Manager before the start of each financial year. The audit programme schedule shall be documented and shall be readily available on QMTEKLIMS server.

Planning for the laboratory audit

The Management team shall establish the laboratory audit objectives and scope. Audit objectives should be consistent with and support the management system policy and its objectives.

Audit objectives shall be based on the following considerations:

- Business risks e.g. legal, contractual and other requirements applicable to the Azuresky (Pty) Ltd;
- Results of the previous audits;
- Process, products and project performance;

Audit Scope shall be based on the Technical and Management Requirements.
The audit shall be notified to all personnel verbally or through production meeting.

The Management team shall discuss and appoint the Lead Auditor.

- The Lead Auditor shall generate the scope of the audit and any necessary requirements to the Auditee at least 24 hours prior to the day of the audit or unless otherwise there is urgent need to conduct the audit with immediate effect.

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Conduct laboratory audit

The audit team shall assess effectiveness of the Quality Management System and compliance to the revelent codes of practice, Laboratory developed methods and Legal Agreements. The audit team shall ensure the audit scope covers technical and/or management system audits.

The Lead Auditor shall on the day of the audit perform the following:

- Conduct the opening meeting
- Introduce the audit team
- Conduct the audit as planned
- Attain all signed off non-conformances (Hardcopy and/or Emailed copy).
- Conduct the closing meeting.
- Issue an audit report to all parties concerned.

Auditors shall on the day of the audit perform the following:

- Conduct the audit as planned
- Record all non-conformances on ASMF 8.7.3 improvement action request
- Classify the non-conformances either as major, minor or observation
- Discuss the outcome of the audit with the Auditee.

Compile report

The report for laboratory audit shall be compiled as follows:

- The Lead Auditor shall compile a draft report.
- The draft report shall be reviewed by any other management team member for correctness and truthfulness of the record.
- The report shall be authorized by any other senior management team member and distribution to all personnel within 12 working days.

The audit report shall provide an accurate and clear record of the audit process and shall include the following:

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- The audit objectives,
- The audit scope,
- Identification of the auditee,
- Identification of audit team and Auditee's participants,
- The dates and locations where the audit activities were conducted
- The audit findings and,
- The audit conclusions.

conduct follow up audit and audit close out

- The Auditee shall within the specified time frame provide the Lead Auditor with evidence of the corrective action implemented.
- The Lead Auditor and the audit team members shall assess the suitability of the evidence of the corrective action submitted by the auditee.
- In the event that the provided corrective actions/evidence are suitable then, the non-conformances shall be closed.
- In the event that the implemented corrective actions provided are not suitable, appropriate action shall be taken to address the gap.
- Should the assessment indicate that the corrective actions are not effectively implemented, then the non-conformance(s) will remain open.
- The Lead Auditor shall conduct the close out sign off the non-conformance indicating the status of the corrective action (Closed/Rejected).
- The copies of non-conformances shall be retained or stored both hardcopy and softcopy.
- The Lead Auditor shall share the audit results at the management review meeting.

Audit records

- All records of the audit evidence shall be readily available both hardcopy and softcopy.

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